

Routing & Rotation

Admin guide for the iLaunchify order-routing control center. Nothing in this guide changes anything on its own — it explains what each control does so you can tune with confidence.

The golden rule — filters first, always

Every routing decision runs **hard eligibility filters before anything else**: capability match, active service + partner, Stripe live, storage/hazmat class, capacity, and blackout dates. Rotation, ratings, and weights only ever reorder the survivors — they can never rescue a partner that failed a filter. And a **manual pick** (a creator's pinned printer, or an offering bound at configuration time) always wins outright: it is never rotated away.

The four tabs

- **Print providers** — who prints a creator's labels / packaging.
- **Fulfillment centers** — which warehouse ships the finished goods.
- **Manufacturers** — which factory produces the product (usually fixed by ownership; the weights only break ties when a template has more than one).
- **Dispatch lifecycle** — what happens after a partner is assigned (accept window, reroute budget, auto-cancel).

Rotation policy — the core controls (Print & FC)

A rotation policy decides how auto-routed work is spread across eligible partners. It is **off by default** — off means the legacy behavior (printers: first eligible; FCs: the weighted-score band). Turn it on per tab and, for printers, per context.

- **Enable** — the master switch. Nothing rotates until this is on.
- **Pool size (top-N)** — only the best N candidates can win. Printers rank by rating; FCs by score (distance / cost / capacity).
- **Split mode** — how the pool shares work: Equal (round-robin, least-recently-awarded wins), Random (uniform), Exact percentages (share per rank, must sum to 100), or Best only (winner-take-all).
- **New-provider / new-node share** — a slice reserved for partners with too few ratings / awards yet, so newcomers can earn a track record. The cap limits concurrent open awards.
- **Rating floor** (printers) — partners below this Bayesian rating drop out of the auto-pool (manual picks still allowed).
- **Location bias** (printers) — nudge toward printers near the producer to cut label-hop freight (0 = rating only).
- **Sticky reorders** (printers) — a repeat order keeps the same printer for color consistency. Approved chains only.

Contexts (Print providers)

Print rotation is tuned separately for three moments: **Production** (bulk — the money runs, consistency matters), **Samples** (the cheapest place to give newcomers a shot — usually a higher new-provider share), and **Replenishment** (repeat small runs — sticky + best-only keeps quality consistent). A context with no row falls back to Production.

Dry-run preview — see before you ship

Both the Print and FC tabs have a preview: pick a product (and quantity) and it runs the **exact production engine** over 100 simulated orders — no awards are written. It shows the eligible pool, ratings / scores, and the projected win share per partner. Use it to sanity-check a policy before enabling it. Pinned or config-bound products are reported honestly (rotation never runs for them).

Weights (FC & Manufacturer tabs)

FC scorer weights rank warehouses by cost, distance, SLA, capacity, rotation fairness, and storage-class match, plus an indifference band (candidates within that % of the best score rotate). **Manufacturer match weights** (capability / proximity / certification) only arbitrate templates with more than one possible manufacturer — most products are fixed to their owner. Weights are relative and renormalize over whatever dimensions have data for an order.

Awards tables + kill switch

Each tab's awards table shows the last 90 days of auto-awards per partner and their actual share — how you see where work really goes vs. what you configured. The **kill switch** ("In pool — exclude") removes a partner from auto-rotation without deactivating them: manual and pinned picks still work. Use it as an ops pressure valve, then reinstate.

Dispatch lifecycle

Accept window — how long a partner has to accept before timeout. **Max auto-reroutes** — the reroute budget per dispatch (settings-driven; live enforcement lands with the dispatch-transition work). **Auto-cancel** — unpaid orders cancel past this age. **Changeover days** — extra lead time per additional flavor in a variety pack. These are post-assignment timers, not selection.

A safe rollout recipe

- 1 Leave rotation **off** and confirm the awards tables look sane.
- 2 Set the weights / pool / mode you want, then run the **preview** and read the split.
- 3 Enable for **Samples** first (cheapest place for mistakes); watch a week of awards.
- 4 Then enable **Production**. Use the kill switch if a partner needs to pause.
- 5 Adjust and re-preview anytime — changes are audited and take effect on the next order.

Glossary

- **Pool** — the top-N candidates eligible to win.
- **Band** — a score window within which FCs rotate as near-ties.
- **Bayesian rating** — a rating smoothed toward a prior, so a partner with 2 reviews isn't treated like one with 200.
- **Cold-start** — seeded exposure for new partners so they can earn ratings / awards.
- **Pinned** — a creator's explicit choice; bypasses rotation entirely.